

Incident Report Analysis

Summary	A multimedia company experienced a denial of service (DoS) attack that disrupted internal network operations for approximately two hours. The attack was caused by a flood of incoming ICMP packets that overwhelmed the company's network resources and prevented normal internal traffic from accessing network services. The cybersecurity team investigated the incident and discovered that the attack entered through an improperly configured firewall. The attacker exploited this weakness to send large amounts of ICMP traffic into the network. During the incident, the incident response team blocked incoming ICMP packets, temporarily disabled non-critical services, and restored critical systems to stabilise network operations. Following the investigation, the organisation implemented additional firewall rules, source IP verification, network monitoring software, and IDS/IPS protections to reduce the likelihood of future attacks.
Identify	The organisation identified the incident as a denial of service (DoS) attack involving an ICMP flood. The attack targeted the company's internal network infrastructure and disrupted access to network resources and services. The investigation identified multiple security weaknesses, including: - Improper firewall configuration - Lack of traffic filtering for ICMP packets - Insufficient network monitoring capabilities - Limited intrusion detection protections Systems affected during the incident included: - Internal network services - Network infrastructure devices - Business-critical network resources The organisation decided that improvements to firewall management, network monitoring, and intrusion detection controls were necessary to strengthen overall network security.
Protect	To improve protection against future attacks, the organisation

	should strengthen firewall configurations and implement stricter network traffic filtering rules. Rate limiting should be applied to ICMP traffic to prevent excessive packet flooding. Additional protective measures should include: - Regular firewall configuration reviews - Network segmentation - Security awareness training for IT staff - Access control reviews - Routine vulnerability assessments The organisation should also keep updated IDS/IPS systems and create documented network security procedures to improve long-term protection.
Detect	The organisation implemented network monitoring software and IDS/IPS solutions to improve visibility into unusual traffic patterns and suspicious activity. To improve detection capabilities further, the organisation should: - Continuously monitor firewall logs - Monitor incoming ICMP traffic - Configure automated alerts for unusual network activity - Implement centralised log monitoring or SIEM solutions - Conduct regular reviews of network traffic patterns Improved monitoring will help the security team find malicious activity more quickly and reduce response times during future incidents.
Respond	During the incident, the response team blocked incoming ICMP packets, disabled non-critical services, and restored critical systems to stabilise operations. To improve future incident response procedures, the organisation should: - Develop a formal incident response plan - Create escalation and communication procedures - Define containment and isolation procedures - Document response workflows for DoS attacks - Conduct incident response exercises and testing The organisation should also improve documentation procedures to make sure security events are recorded accurately for future analysis and reporting.
Recover	The organisation restored critical network services after blocking the malicious traffic and stabilising network operations.

	To improve recovery capabilities in the future, the organisation should: - Create disaster recovery procedures - Create backup and restoration plans - Test recovery procedures regularly - Maintain system recovery documentation - Improve business continuity planning The organisation should also review lessons learned from the incident and use the findings to improve security controls, recovery processes, and prepare for future incidents.
--	--